GRDS 220	Introduction to Digital Media	3(3,0)
In this course, students will develop a solid foundation in the tools and techniques of Adobe Illustrator and Adobe Photoshop. Students will learn the difference between vector-based and pixel-based programs and how to integrate both work fields to produce creative graphics. Moreover, students will be briefly introduced to Adobe InDesign, including its workspace, functions, and tools.		

GRDS 222	Advanced Digital Media	3(3,0)
The first section of the course teaches students advanced tools and techniques in Adobe Illustrator (mesh 3D) and Adobe Photoshop (masks). The second part emphasizes learning technical skills in Adobe InDesign, a computer-based page layout software. Students will learn to use master pages, style sheets, typographic controls, and flow and format text; place and manipulate images; combine images and text; create tables, gradients, and PDFs; and correctly prepare digital files for offset printing. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 220.		

GRDS 230	Photography I	3(3,0)
This course teaches students the basics of black-and-white digital photography. It is a lecture-based course with extensive hands-on practical training. Students learn how to develop an eye for photography and for framing objects. They also enhance their knowledge of the different parts of a camera and the mechanisms of film printing and development while continuously scanning other photographers' work in contemporary and historical scenes.		

GRDS 300	Illustration	3(2,2)
This class is designed to introduce students to the art of illustration and visual storytelling. It teaches students a range of technical skills to enhance their ideas and creativity. This class allows students to discover their style through line quality, colors, and shapes. Students will be aided in developing their own ‘style’ through visual analysis and personal visions. Hands-on projects will help enhance ideas and techniques such as ink and brush, scraperboard, monoprints, watercolor, relief printing, and collage. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 220; FADR 202.		

GRDS 305	Type II	3(3,0)
This intermediate-level course studies the marriage of Latin and Arabic typography. This course develops students' ability to create typographic designs by visually and aesthetically merging Arabic and Latin Fonts. This multi-script combination targets the needs of our direct Arab and Lebanese markets. Students will learn to dissect fonts, create modules, experiment with type, generate Arabic adaptations, and construct typographical patterns that evolve into 3D objects. The student further learns the rules of the typographic grid system and experiments with breaking the Grid when designing layouts, spreads, and posters. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 205.		

GRDS 306	Type III	3(3,0)
This course focuses on Arabic typography, its history, and the modern approaches to enhance our Arabic fonts. Students will learn the anatomy of the Arabic type to manipulate its parts creatively. Projects will include creating an experimental display of Arabic font, arabesques, Arabic graffiti, and Arabic adaptations. The skills acquired in previous type classes will equip students with the techniques needed to explore further how typography, particularly Arabic, can serve as a communicative tool. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 222; GRDS 305.		

GRDS 310	Design I	3(2,2)
This course investigates the creative process the designer goes through while designing the main elements of visual communication: symbols, pictograms, icons, and logos. Students will be asked to create a visual vocabulary (corporate identity) that is credible enough to convince the target audience to purchase a specific product or service. It is an in-depth insight into planning and developing a corporate image, including logos and other business communication applications. In addition, students learn to design a complete restaurant branding image from the initial concept to the final execution. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 203; GRDS 220.		

GRDS 311	Design II	3(2,2)
This course provides a general overview of design principles for packaging design's structure and visual aspects, packaging history, and consumer decision-making psychology. The use of graphic imagery and innovative die-cuts across various packages and packaging materials will be examined. Key course concepts will include researching and designing 3D packages, understanding eco-friendly and sustainable packaging, experimenting with playful and conceptual packaging design, and defining the target audience to design the best packaging solution. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 310.		

GRDS 335	Production	3(3,0)
In this course, students will develop an understanding of the “process flow” of contemporary print production methods. The course covers the entire production timeline: Prepress, Press, and Postpress. In addition to printing technologies, students will learn about various types of ink and paper, binding, varnishes, finishing techniques, and the effect of the printing process on the product. Students will also learn how to handle projects and deal with clients as freelance designers or as designers working for companies. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 222.		

GRDS 345	History of Graphic Design	3(3,0)
This course covers the evolution of graphic communication from prehistory through postmodern design and the digital revolution. This course provides graphic design students with the knowledge and understanding of the places, people, and events, as well as historical and cultural factors and technological innovations that have influenced the development of graphic design into the practice known today. Historical awareness provides a meaningful context for young designers to evolve and contribute positively to the cultures in which they live and work. **Prerequisite**: FADR 215.		

GRDS 360	Visual Perception & Infographics	3(3,0)
Visual perception is the ability to interpret information from our surroundings through visible light that reaches the eye. This course will explore the various theories of visual perception with an emphasis on Gestalt theory and its relation to Graphic Design. It will create an understanding of our human visual perception and its limitations. Students will also be given projects in which they will apply Gestalt principles and the theories they have learned. In addition to visual perception theories, students will learn two key design disciplines: Infographics and Wayfinding. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 311.		

GRDS 399	Co-op Training Experience	1(1,0)
Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. This Co-op work experience is usually fulfilled during the summer semester of the third year in the program. Students must submit a formal report and poster and make a formal presentation about their Co-op experience. **Prerequisites***:* ENGL 217; Senior Standing.		

GRDS 409	Design Writing Research	3(3,0)
In this course, students will explore various research methodologies to develop the skills needed to write a well-rounded research paper for their final-year design project. They will be exposed to visual analysis tools, enabling them to articulate their understanding and appreciation of a given visual. Students will engage in writing exercises focused on various topics in the design field. By the end of this course, students should develop their senior project research proposal. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 310.		

GRDS 411	Design III	3(2,2)
This course prepares students for the design challenges of creating professional-looking layouts for editorial content (newsletters, reports, books, & magazines) and on-screen (websites and web applications). Students learn to create multi-page publications and on-screen interfaces with effective typography, images, illustrations, and layouts. The core focus of this course is working with user interactivity, composition, layout, format, negative space, grids, type, and graphical elements. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 311, GRDS 306.		

GRDS 412	Design IV	3(2,2)
This course focuses on creating a final-year project that bridges theory and practice in visual communication through an extensive exploration of the design process. Students will research, develop, and design their senior projects to demonstrate their visual communication ability. This class provides students with a forum to showcase their talent and skills. Emphasis is placed on creativity and quality of work. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 411, GRDS 409.		

GRDS 423	Motion Graphics	3(3,0)
A rapidly expanding and thriving field, motion graphics gives designers new opportunities to work in television, film, and web design. This course focuses on motion		

graphics and its diverse methodologies to lay down the necessary specialized essentials. Adobe After Effects and Flash teach the foundations of compositing, video editing, and special effects. Assignments center on upholding a certain amount of experimentation and are process-oriented. Students will learn to animate graphics and type to communicate ideas better visually. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 220.

GRDS 424	**Web and Interactive Design**	**3(3,0)**
As the World Wide Web became a fundamental fixture of life, it became essential for design to ensure that any interface is accessible, exciting, and effective. This course examines the ever-evolving field of User Interface and User Experience Design. It combines web and application design as a communication medium with a distinctive user experience. Instruction focuses on achieving a crucial balance among form and function, visual design and effectiveness, and accessible navigation and communication. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 423.		

GRDS 440	**Design and Social Impact**	**3(3,0)**
This course prepares students to become leading agents of social change through community engagement. It aims to promote collaboration between computer science and graphic design students to develop effective solutions to existing community issues. The course is structured around a balance of classroom theory, extensive field research, and the implementation of a real-world solution that draws on both. **Prerequisite:** Junior standing.		

GRDS 450	**Branding & Advertising**	**3(3,0)**
This course explains both branding & advertising and their relationship to each other. It explores the history of advertising and discusses the most influential and transformative periods it has undergone (from billboards to radio, TV, and social media). It also emphasizes the importance of advertising in defining and differentiating a product within our contemporary mass market. This course includes hands-on experience applying advertising and branding concepts and techniques in a complete campaign: creating a product, identifying competitors, defining the target audience, conducting marketing research, designing the package, and developing the ad campaign, from press ads to billboards. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 411.		

GRDS 452	**Digital Illustration**	**2(1,2)**
Digital illustration uses digital tools, software, and applications to create complex images and illustrations. This course teaches students a range of techniques and approaches to producing fresh, creative, and aesthetically pleasing illustrations. Students will receive hands-on training in basic drawing and painting, as well as in manipulating and creating vector-based graphics, illustrations, and digital paintings. Projects include various areas, from comic strips to 3-D rendering. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 222; GRDS 300.		

II. Elective Courses

Descriptions of the major elective courses are given below.

GRDS 320	UI / UX Design	3(3,0)
This course combines digital technology and creative design to create an interactive App prototype. It emphasizes the efficient use of Adobe XD as a testing and prototyping tool. Students will be asked to implement digital design research methods in the study of User Experience, including forming proto-personas, journey maps, site maps, red routes, sketches, and wireframes, which will then be transformed into a clickable application. In addition, students will learn to design a complete app design (Logo and In-App Screen designs) from A to Z. After the application design, students will implement the evaluation criteria to user-test the app for improvement. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 220.		

GRDS 330	Photography II – Photography for Social Media	3(3,0)
This course emphasizes developing a critical eye and using photography as a form of self-expression and an artistic medium for social media posts. Students are expected to have a working knowledge of the photographic process. Students will produce photographic posts for real-life brand products. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 230.		

GRDS 331	Digital Processing	3(2,2)
Digital photography is now a standard set, ranging from compacts to medium-format sensor-size cameras. Through Adobe Photoshop and Lightroom, this course will give students a wider understanding of digital processing and important attributes. An image taken from the camera certainly needs modifications to get the best out of it. With that, pictures will look the way we intend them to, following precise adjustments and an understanding of why and what the result will be. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 222.		

GRDS 350	3D Printing & Prototyping	3(2,2)
This course focuses on the fundamental 3D design and model-making process. It will follow the process that industrial designers use to create 3D-printed products. The course will cover the design thinking process for bringing initial sketch ideas to life while considering limitations. Multiple software applications will be used to design the 3D models, including Adobe Photoshop, Autodesk Maya, and Pixologic ZBrush. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 222.		

GRDS 355	Calligraphy	3(2,2)
In this course, students will learn the basics of Arabic calligraphy as defined by Ibn Muqla. Variations in the main Arabic scripts are explained through a set of visual examples. The course touches upon Islamic calligraphy as a communicative and embellishing technique in the visual arts. The practical aspect of the course explores the techniques and rules of drawing letters of the main standardized Arabic Script. Calligraphy will also be used to create modern visual expressions. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 305.		

GRDS 375	3D Animation	3(3,0)
In the first section of this course, students will learn Autodesk Maya. They will explore 3D form and space, emphasizing digital modeling of real-life objects. They will develop		

and construct 3D objects intended graphically for any design or animation use. The course covers basic to intermediate 3D modeling skills, with an emphasis on texturing and lighting. Maxwell Realflow, an industry standard for fluid simulation, will be covered in the second part of this course. Water simulation and dynamics will be taught and integrated into Maya for rendering. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 423.

GRDS 385	**VR Illustration & Sculpting**	**3(3,0)**

Virtual Reality is a new technology tool used for game and art production. Its concept has been around for a long time, but it was only recently viewed as a novelty. In this course, students can acquire this new skill for the fast-growing design market. They will learn illustration in virtual space using the Oculus app and TiltBrush, and sculpting in Oculus Medium, which replaces the usual computer software, ZBrush or Photoshop. Future developments in Oculus will allow students to print their models on 3D printers. **Prerequisite***:* GRDS300

GRDS 381	**Bookbinding**	**3(2,2)**

This class teaches students various bookbinding techniques: Japanese binding, accordion folding, and signature binding. This course will cover the bookbinding process from the initial concept to the finished, bound book. Multiple types of bookmaking will be covered, along with detailed explanations of the advantages and disadvantages of each binding. A creative approach to a design problem will be addressed, using book design as a form of art.

GRDS 402	**Silkscreen**	**3(2,2)**

Silkscreen is one of the most flexible and widely used types of printmaking. The class focuses on various silkscreen techniques taught through demonstrations and specific projects. Images and graphics will be created using hand-drawn separations, photographic film, digital separations, and photocopied images. Water-based silkscreen inks are used, allowing for soap-and-water cleanup. Students will be encouraged to experiment with multiple techniques and combinations of traditional and contemporary methods. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 300.

GRDS 403	**Painting**	**3(2,2)**

This course introduces various painting materials, skills, and techniques. It helps students develop artistic potential to create a range of moods. Students will learn to use the brush to create different strokes and manipulate colors to suit their concepts. Color theory will be discussed in class. The course includes detailed studies of still life, landscape, and the human figure. **Prerequisite**: FADR 202.

GRDS 431	**Critical Theory**	**3(3,0)**

This course is an introduction to graphic design theory. It explores the aesthetic and social purposes of design practice through written selections spanning a century of design evolution. Students will read about design to stimulate growth and change in their work. Students will also learn how to analyze and critically write design essays.

This course also puts theory into practice, and students can manually experiment with past and present theories. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 305; GRDS 310.

GRDS 436	**Game Design**	**3(2,2)**
Turning ideas into reality, the game design course is a hands-on experience in translating concepts, character sketches, storyboards, and animations into finalized elements for use in the game industry. Students will explore the process of designing meaningful experiences for the players. Working in groups with the computer science students, students will design and develop a 2D/3D game that the public can download and test. **Prerequisites**: GRDS 220		

GRDS 498	**Special Topics in Graphic Design**	**3(3,0)**
A special topic course to be defined based on current and evolving design trends and technological advancements. Students will be able to explore various topics under the vast design umbrella.		